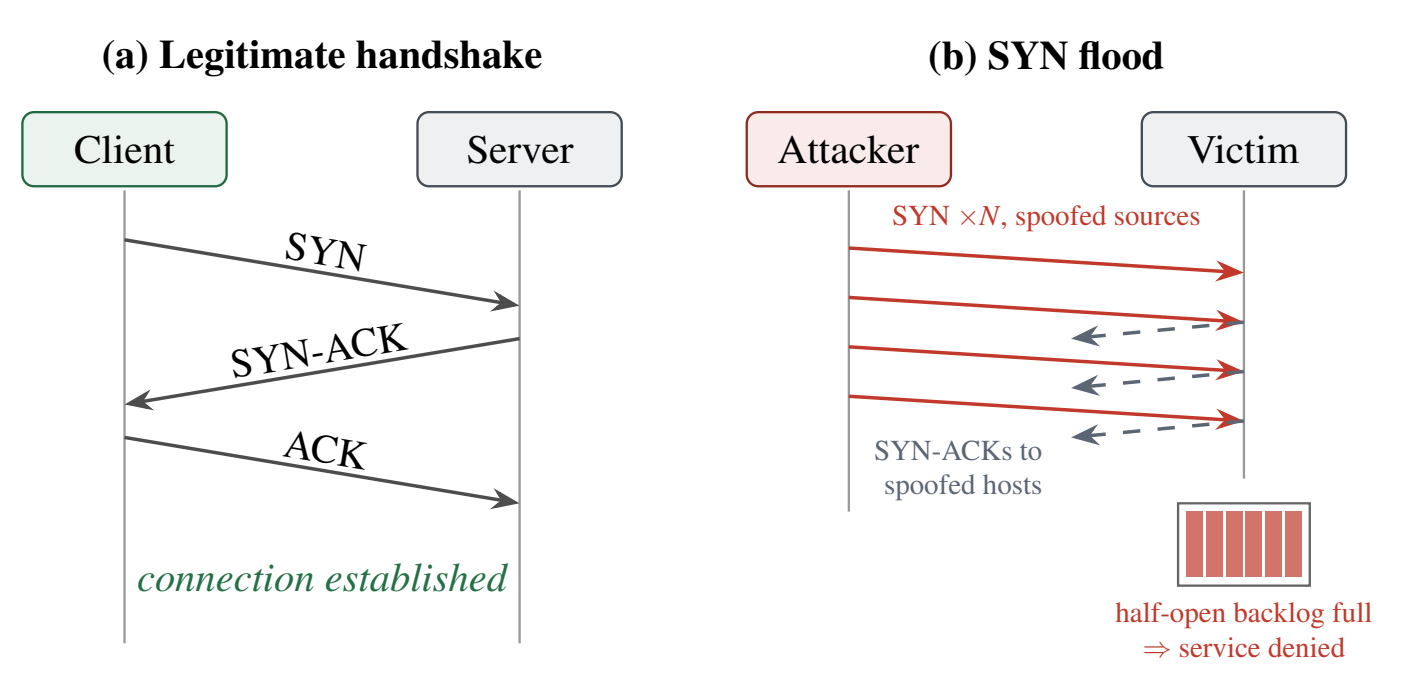
(a) Legitimate handshake
Client
Server
SYN
SYN-ACK
ACK
connection established
(b) SYN flood
Attacker
Victim
SYN ×N, spoofed sources
SYN-ACKs to
spoofed hosts
half-open backlog full
⇒ service denied